Larkspur Labs Employee Handbook

Welcome to Larkspur Labs. We build scheduling and workflow software for small independent clinics, and we are a company of about 140 people spread across Portland, Chicago, and a lot of home offices. This handbook explains how we work together. It is meant to be read once, skimmed often, and argued with when something does not make sense. If a policy here seems wrong or unclear, tell your manager or write to people@larkspur-labs.example and we will fix the handbook.

Working at Larkspur

Our principles

We try to make decisions by four principles. Be kind and direct. Write things down. Ship small and learn. Leave things better than you found them. Most of the policies below are just those principles applied to a specific situation.

Working hours and location

Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 Pacific. Outside those hours you are free to organize your day around your life. You are welcome to work from home, from the Portland or Chicago office, or from a mix. If you plan to work from somewhere other than your home country for more than two weeks, check with People Operations first because of tax and legal rules.

Leave

Paid time off (PTO)

Full-time employees receive 20 days of paid time off per year. PTO accrues monthly, at roughly 1.67 days per month, starting on your first day. You can book time off as soon as it has accrued, and your manager will approve requests within two business days. We ask for at least two weeks of notice for anything longer than three days.

Unused PTO carries over from one calendar year to the next, but carry-over is capped at 5 days. Anything above 5 days on December 31 expires. We do not pay out accrued PTO except where local law requires it. We would much rather you actually take your time off, so please plan to use it.

New hires who start mid-year accrue from their start date, so your first-year total is prorated by month.

Company holidays

Larkspur observes 8 company holidays, a few optional floating holidays, and a winter break between December 24 and January 1. The full list is in the Holiday Calendar. Company holidays do not count against your PTO balance.

Sick and family leave

Sick days are separate from PTO and are not capped. If you are unwell, tell your team in Slack and take the time you need. A doctor's note is not required for short absences. Parental leave is 16 weeks fully paid for the birth or adoption of a child, for every parent, and can be taken in one block or split across the first year. Bereavement leave is up to 5 paid days for an immediate family member and 3 for extended family.

Benefits

Overview

Larkspur offers medical, dental, and vision coverage, a 401(k) with company matching, and a yearly learning stipend. The Benefits Guide has the full details and plan names. You must enroll within 30 days of your start date, otherwise you will need to wait for open enrollment in November or a qualifying life event.

Retirement and wellbeing

The company matches 401(k) contributions dollar for dollar up to 4% of your salary, vested immediately. Every employee has a $1,200 annual learning stipend for books, courses, and conferences, and a $50 monthly wellness allowance. Our employee assistance program offers free, confidential counseling for you and your household.

Conduct

Code of conduct

We expect everyone to treat colleagues, customers, and partners with respect. Harassment, discrimination, and retaliation are never acceptable, whether in person, in Slack, in email, or at an offsite. If you see or experience something that concerns you, you can talk to your manager, to People Operations, or to our independent reporting line, which is run by a third party and can be anonymous. Every report is taken seriously and nobody is penalized for raising a concern in good faith.

Conflicts of interest and confidentiality

Please tell your manager before taking on outside work that overlaps with Larkspur's business. Customer data is confidential. Never share it outside the company, and never paste it into tools we have not approved. The IT and Security Policy explains which tools are approved.

Speaking up about mistakes

Everyone makes mistakes. We would rather hear about one early than discover it late. Blameless write-ups are standard practice, and nobody is punished for an honest error that they report promptly.

Expenses

What you can expense

You may expense reasonable costs that you incur doing your job: travel booked through our travel tool, team meals, software subscriptions approved by your manager, and home office equipment up to $750 in your first month. Submit expenses in the finance tool within 30 days with a receipt attached.

Approval limits

Your manager approves expenses up to $500. Anything between $500 and $2,500 also needs your department lead. Anything above that needs the finance team in advance. When in doubt, ask before you spend. Personal items, alcohol outside of team events, and fines are not reimbursable.

Reimbursement timing

Approved expenses are reimbursed in the next regular payroll run, usually within two weeks.